

Dancing dolphins

Dolphins form spectacular displays as they leap out of the water. They are often friendly to humans and can be incredibly nosy. There are about 26 different types, or species. One way of identifying different species is through their markings.

The dolphins take a breath as they leap out of the water, but continue to swim forward.

This leap-swim action is called "porpoising."

Bottlenose dolphins can leap several yards into the air.

A friend to all

Bottlenose dolphins are one of the best-known of all dolphins, and there are many stories of them helping people in trouble.